Four-day carboplatin and fluorouracil with radiotherapy

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00589 · Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Before your first visit

Full blood count, kidney and liver tests; review medicines, allergies, weight, oral intake and symptoms. dihydropyrimidine dehydrogenase (a medicine-processing enzyme) (DPD) testing before first fluorouracil unless already tested; kidney measurement and hearing assessment as indicated. Arrange dental and swallowing/nutrition review before head and neck radiation.

STEP 2

Time in the unit

Carboplatin runs over 30 minutes on each of Days 1–4. Fluorouracil runs continuously over 96 hours; the source also permits a separate 22-hour infusion on each of Days 1–4. Confirm the actual pump or bag-change and disconnection times.

STEP 3

Keep one calendar

Chemotherapy is given only during radiotherapy. If radiation is interrupted, contact the team before the next chemotherapy dose. Radiation oncology sets the radiation visits and follow-up.

STEP 4

Leaving the unit

Confirm the next tests, medicines, treatment dates and verified daytime and out-of-hours contact numbers.

STEP 5

Practical help

Ask about transport, work, costs, communication needs and whether a support person can attend.

Sources: NCCP 00589 v5: retrieved official regimen. Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.